never be overestimated, given its reputation of rich resources waiting to be exploited. In his famous Railway Minute of 1853 outlining railway policy in India, Lord Dalhousie had also discussed the military importance of the railway system. The truth of Stephenson's and Dalhousie's apprehensions was tested sooner than perhaps they themselves would have imagined—in the 1857 Revolt. [66]

After 1857, lines were built more speedily and strategically, and railway stations were fortified, some resembling forts.

When the Mutiny erupted, the lines in operation were short and confined to the hinterlands of the Calcutta and Bombay ports. The rebellion in Bombay was squashed even before it could start, and most of the action was in Bihar, Uttar Pradesh and Delhi, in areas covered by the East Indian Railway. [67]

DEFENDING A STATION FOR 32 HOURS ON A WATER TANK

An 1858 Mutiny report in *The Illustrated London News* of an incident at a railway station called Barwarie, 23 miles from Allahabad, describes the plight of railway engineers and their families—fourteen people in all—who escaped to the station's water tank and defended themselves for 32 hours from a mob that tried to burn down the tank, threw stones at it and did everything possible to kill the people. Reported by an Allahabad correspondent, it takes us to the scene and narrates to us the intensity of the Mutiny on the ground.

East Indian Railway Water Tank at Barwarie Defended against Mutineers

> I send you a sketch of a railway water tank at Barwarie, twenty-three miles from Allahabad. The village in the distance is Barwarie. The dimensions of the tank were about 16 feet high, 22 feet long, 24 feet broad, and depth of tank 4 feet [*sic*].
>
> On Sunday, the 7th June, 1857, at noon, the day after the massacre at Allahabad, P.O. Snow, railway engineer, Mr J. Rose, Mr Mathers, Mr Lethbridge, wife and child, Mr J. Keymer, wife and three children, Mr R. Keymer, all employed on the railway, and Major and Mrs Ryves, were assembled at the latter's bungalow at Barwarie, when information was brought that Mr Lancaster, an inspector, had been murdered, a mile off, when trying to join the above party.
>
> Immediately on receiving this news, Mr Ryves and the women and children were assisted up to the top of the tank, we men intending to come down again for provisions,